

The easiest way to spoil a landscape shot is to take a diagonal shot of the landscape. This need not even be intentional. Even a slight tilt in the camera while framing a landscape can ruin the photograph. The easiest fix for this is to carry around a tripod. These are lightweight, and will significantly improve the quality of your photographs. If a tripod is not available, make sure that the horizon is as horizontal as possible before clicking. This simple check can bring about dramatic differences in the quality of your photos.

The “landscape” mode of your camera gives a deep focus, which means almost everything in the frame will be in focus. If you want to bring out the expanse, make sure to include objects close to the lens. This could be a rock, a tree, or even much larger objects like a cliff or a mountain. Changing the focus settings to focus on a narrow plane of focus dramatically changes the landscape. While this is not normally done, when implemented, this effect makes the photograph look like a shot of a miniature set. This is because the narrow plane of focus is normally associated with macro photography. This technique is called tilt-shift photography, and gives great results when experimenting from high vantage points taking photos of cityscapes or urban areas.

5.5 Night

Taking photographs in the night can be a challenging process. Even while indoors, the night time can give bad results. One of the most common mistakes is that the flash is so bright that everything within the frame is exposed. This is a result of a too powerful flash in many cameras. This can be countered by a very thin piece of paper over the flash, or a strip of scotch tape. Another common mistake is that the white balance in the camera is not adjusted for the light. Focus on a blank sheet of paper, or change the white balance settings according to the source of light. When taking photos in extremely low-light conditions, it makes sense to use a tripod and ask the subject to stay still.

Most night photos require high ISO settings, so a tripod is almost a must. The photos tend to be grainy and shaky even with a tripod. When taking portraits at night, make the person stand approximately four to six feet away, then zoom in